
HACKATHON RULEBOOK

Cricka-Thon 26 — Official Reference Document

TERMINOLOGY NOTE

RUNS = Points system mechanics for the **scoring sheet** (earned/lost during the hackathon for performance)

POINTS = Mechanics for the **auction purse** (budget used to bid during pre-hackathon auction)

1. PRE-HACKATHON & AUCTION

Duration: 1 hour | Before the hackathon begins, all teams participate in an IPL-style auction to recruit a Player Icon (working professional) who will support them during the event.

Opening Wallet	Each team starts with 100 Points for the auction.
Player Icons	Working professionals whose profiles are displayed on the auction dashboard.
Bidding	Teams bid Points from their wallet to acquire a Player Icon (5-min live auction).
Uncapped Division	Single players not selected in auction remain available post-auction for direct connection.
PS Declaration	Problem Statement is flashed. Teams get a 5-min window to declare their chosen PS on their personalised dashboard.

Sequence of Events

- **Intro session** — Concept, rules, auction mechanics, DRS, Retentions, and extra time explained. (10 min)
- **Player profiles displayed** — All Player Icon profiles shown on the auction dashboard. (5 min)
- **Auction begins** — 100 Points per team wallet. (5 min)
- **Post-auction buffer** — Teams connect with their selected Player Icon. (5 min)
- **PS flash** — Problem Statements revealed on dashboard. (1 min)
- **PS decision buffer** — Teams declare their Problem Statement on their personalised dashboard. (5 min)

2. RETENTIONS

A Retention allows a team to use a tool or technology outside the given tech stack, subject to volunteer approval.

- If a team needs a tool not in the provided tech stack, they call for a Retention.
- A volunteer is assigned to evaluate the request. The volunteer must ask the team:
 - What is the intent of the tool?
 - How specifically will it be used?
 - Why this tool and not an alternative?
 - What alternatives were considered?
- Retention is granted only after the volunteer or jury agrees.
- Each approved Retention costs the team 10 Points from their wallet.

-10 Points

Cost per Retention - can retain 2

3. HACKATHON ENVIRONMENT

Setup at each team's round table:

- IPL-style paddles for raising signals (DRS, Quick Single, Strategic Timeout)
- Printed rulebook and glossary sheet
- Dashboard login credentials for the team

4. POWERPLAY STRUCTURE

The hackathon is divided into four timed Powerplays, each focused on a distinct phase of development. All timers are tracked publicly.

Powerplay	Focus Area	Duration	Movement Rule
PP 1	Complete UI	30 min	One contestant per team may circulate the arena for cross-team discussion.
PP 2	Frontend	50 min	No shuffling. All contestants return to their tables.
PP 3	Backend	75 min	No movement. Backend focus. +10–15 min buffer available if needed.
PP 4	Presentation & Ideation	20 min	No movement. Hackathon period ends when PP 4 concludes.

5. POWERPLAY SCORECARD

Umpires conduct a progress check with every team at the end of each Powerplay. These observations directly inform the Match Referee's scoring decisions.

What Umpires Evaluate:

- Effectiveness of work completed during the Powerplay

- Alignment of work with the declared Problem Statement
- Overall team workability and collaboration

Timing Penalties (Runs):

Scenario	Runs Impact
Completed on time or within Powerplay window	No penalty
Exceeded by up to 5 minutes	-2 Runs
Exceeded by more than 5 minutes	-5 Runs
Exceeded by 10 minutes or more	Zero Runs for that Powerplay

6. STRATEGIC TIMEOUT

A structured break that teams can use for regrouping, snacks, or informal discussion with the Match Referees.

When	Before or at the end of PP 2 and PP 4.
Duration	5 minutes — free of charge.
Mandatory	Every team must declare at least one Strategic Timeout during the hackathon.
Extension	An additional 5 minutes can be requested from the umpires.
Extension Cost	10 Points deducted from the team wallet.

Free Standard Timeout	-10 Points Extension (5 min)
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7. DRS — DOUBT RESOLUTION SYSTEM

Teams can request an exclusive one-on-one session with a Match Referee for guidance, advice, or clarification at any point during the hackathon.

Invocation	Raise the IPL paddle at your table to call an umpire.
Allowance	Each team gets 2 DRS sessions for the entire hackathon.
Timing	Can be invoked at any time during the hackathon.
Duration	10 minutes of exclusive time with the Match Referee.
Referee Request	Teams may request a specific Match Referee for their DRS.
Cost	10 Points deducted from the wallet per DRS invoked.

Outcomes (Runs):

+10 Runs Advice taken into account	-10 Points Cost to invoke DRS	-5 Runs Advice ignored
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- Both outcomes (taken or ignored) are reflected on the scoring sheet by the Match Referee.

8. QUICK SINGLE

A voluntary, high-risk high-reward challenge a team can invoke at any time to earn bonus Runs — or risk losing them.

How It Works:

- **Step 1 — Invoke:** Raise the IPL paddle. An umpire comes to the table and reviews current project status.
- **Step 2 — Choose:** The umpire presents two execution options. The team picks one — no take-backs.
- **Step 3 — Execute:** The team has 10 minutes to complete the chosen option. The umpire stays at the table throughout.
- **Step 4 — Review:** At the 10-minute mark, the umpire assesses completion on the spot.

Umpire Observation Criteria:

- Completeness of the solution within the time window
- Team collaboration and execution rapport
- Any unfair practices during the challenge

+10 Runs Solution completed in time	-10 Runs Solution not completed
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9. PRESENTATION & EVALUATION

End of Hackathon

- All teams stop execution immediately after PP 4 concludes.
- Teams must submit: working project, presentation deck (PPT), and GitHub repository.
- 5-minute buffer between submission close and evaluation start.

Presentation Round (All Teams):

- Every team gets a guaranteed presentation slot, irrespective of selection in the Super Over.
- Presentation window: 5 minutes per team.
- Q&A: 2 minutes immediately after each presentation.

Super Over — Top 4 Teams:

Format	Qualifier 1 → Eliminator → Qualifier 2
Time Per Team	3 minutes to present
Allowed	Working demo only — no PPT slides
Winner Criteria	Team that best explains the concept AND demonstrates the working solution

10. COMPLETE SCORING SUMMARY

Quick reference for all Runs and Points mechanics.

Runs (Scoring Sheet)

Action	Type	Runs
DRS — advice taken into account	Bonus	+10
Quick Single — completed in time	Bonus	+10
Powerplay — exceeded by up to 5 min	Penalty	-2
Powerplay — exceeded by more than 5 min	Penalty	-5
Powerplay — exceeded by 10+ min	Penalty	Zero for PP
DRS — advice ignored	Penalty	-5
Quick Single — not completed in time	Penalty	-10

Points (Auction Purse)

Action	Type	Points
Starting auction purse (every team)	Starting	100
Retention — each approved skill	Spend	-10
DRS — each session invoked	Spend	-10
Strategic Timeout — extension (5 min)	Spend	-10

This document is the single source of truth for the hackathon. All roles — umpires, volunteers, match referees, and contestants — are expected to operate strictly within these rules. For ambiguities not covered here, the Match Referee's decision is final.